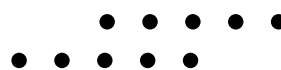


**A Brief for the
Development of a
Learning Management System
for the
Upskill Educational Initiative's Teacher
Immersion Course Program.**



TEACHER IMMERSION COURSE

Learning Management System

Requirements Brief

Introduction

This brief describes the Learning Management System (LMS) for the Teacher Immersion Course (TIC). We believe the developer can contribute expertise on how best to build it.

We have separated our requirements into two categories:

- **Flexible** — standard LMS capabilities where we describe what we need and welcome your recommendations on approach, tooling, and platform.
- **Fixed** — our assessment framework and delivery model, which are specific to this programme and largely fixed. These are the parts that make our course distinctive.

1. Programme Context

The Teacher Immersion Course is a 36-week, ~180-hour blended teacher-training programme run by Upskill Education Initiatives. It combines in-person teaching, self-directed online learning, reflective work, and a school-based practicum. Participants are graduates and school workers building or formalising their teaching competencies.

Because it is an immersion programme, its purpose is to measure change — in knowledge, professional attitude, and classroom practice — not just performance at a single point. That principle shapes everything about the assessment model described in Section 3.

Who uses the system

Role	What they do
Participants	Follow the schedule, access content, submit work, receive feedback and grades.
Facilitators	Deliver and grade the course, give written feedback, observe teaching, produce cohort reports.
External assessors	Independently moderate a sample of graded work for quality assurance.
Programme director / admin	Set up cohorts, configure the course, oversee certification, review reports.

2. Standard LMS Capabilities

These are conventional LMS features. We describe the need; we are open to your recommendation on how to deliver each.

2.1 Users & access

- Role-based accounts and permissions for the four roles above.
- Secure sign-in (single sign-on desirable), password recovery, and profile management.
- Ability to run several cohorts at once without their data mixing.

2.2 Course content & delivery

- Host and organise content: documents, reading packs, links, and embedded video (from an external video tool — we do not need to host video ourselves).
- A clear schedule/calendar each participant can follow, showing sessions, deadlines, and what is due next.
- Discussion boards for online tasks and peer interaction.
- Notifications and reminders (email, and SMS if practical) for deadlines and feedback.

2.3 Submissions & feedback

- Participants upload written work and other files; submissions are timestamped and versioned.
- Facilitators grade, leave written feedback, and return work — ideally before the next module begins.
- Support resubmission where a participant needs to retake a component.

2.4 Reporting & administration

- Dashboards showing cohort progress, outstanding submissions, and grading backlog.
- Exportable reports (PDF and spreadsheet).
- An audit trail of grades and grade changes.

2.5 Practical / non-functional needs

- Responsive web access (works on laptop and mobile browser).
- Reliable where connectivity is patchy — grading and classroom observation should tolerate brief drops.
- Data handled in line with Nigerian data-protection expectations (NDPR).
- Reasonable performance for a full cohort using it at once.

3. Our Assessment Framework

This section is largely fixed

The rules below define how we assess participants and are the heart of the programme. The system must implement them faithfully. Where you see an opportunity to build these more elegantly, we welcome the suggestion — but the underlying rules should not change.

3.1 Three assessment domains

Every participant is assessed across three domains, each independently weighted. A key rule: a participant must pass each domain on its own. Doing well in one domain cannot make up for failing another.

Domain	Weight	Measures	Min pass
Knowledge & Understanding	30%	What they know and can explain	40%
Attitudes & Dispositions	20%	What they value and reflect on	40%
Professional Competence	50%	What they can do in a classroom	40%
Overall aggregate	100%	Programme achievement	50%

3.2 What makes up each domain

Each domain is built from several assessed instruments. Repeated instruments (e.g. five assignments) are averaged, then converted to their weighting.

Domain	Instruments (weight)
Knowledge (30%)	Exit test (10%) · Module assignments ×5 (10%) · Case studies ×2 (10%)
Attitudes (20%)	Reflective journal ×3 (10%) · Growth portfolio (5%) · Participation (5%)
Competence (50%)	Lesson-plan portfolio ×3 (15%) · Micro-teaching ×5 (15%) · Practicum ×2 (20%)

3.3 How grading works

- Each instrument is graded against a defined rubric. We use two kinds: written work scored on weighted criteria, and live teaching scored on a 1–4 scale across set criteria.
- The system should hold the rubrics and do the arithmetic — averaging repeated components and converting to the correct weighting.
- Every grade should carry written feedback that justifies it (this matters for moderation).
- Weightings and pass thresholds should be configurable by us, not hard-coded, so we can adjust future cohorts.

3.4 External moderation

An external assessor independently checks a sample of graded work for consistency. The system should support:

- Automatically selecting a sample of work at set rates, always including borderline cases.
- Letting the assessor record an independent score and comparing it to the facilitator's.
- Flagging any gap greater than 10% for discussion, and routing unresolved disagreements to a third marker. The assessor cannot overwrite marks on their own.

3.5 Certification

A certificate is awarded only when all of the following are met. Missing any of the completion requirements (attendance, all submissions, minimum teaching standards) blocks certification regardless of the overall score.

Requirement	Standard
Attendance	At least 80% of contact hours
All coursework submitted	5 assignments, 3 journals, 2 case studies, 3 lesson plans

Requirement	Standard
Micro-teaching	≥ 5 assessed sessions, average 'Developing' or above
Practicum	Both observations, average 'Developing' or above
Overall score	≥ 50% aggregate AND ≥ 40% in every domain

4. Our Delivery Model

This section is largely fixed

The course structure below is designed and should be represented in the system. We are open to your ideas on how to present it to participants and facilitators.

4.1 Structure: 8 phases across 36 weeks

The programme runs as eight themed phases. The system should represent this structure and let participants move through it week by week.

Phase	Weeks	Theme
0	1	Orientation & baseline (entry test, goal-setting)
1	2–5	Knowing the learner
2	6–9	Building the classroom
3	10–12	Assessing & documenting learning
4	13	Knowing self & community
5	14–15	Leveraging technology (elective)
6	16	Navigating policy
7	17–28	Practising in a real school (elective)
8	29–36	Synthesis & demonstration

4.2 Four kinds of learning activity

- **Facilitated** — In-person facilitated sessions.
- **Self-directed learning** — 18 embedded independent tasks, each producing an output that feeds an assessment. Around 30% of total hours.
- **Reflective** — reflective seminars where participants examine their own practice.
- **Practicum** — school-based teaching with formal observation.

4.3 Two things we especially care about

- **Measuring growth** — Because we measure change, the system should make it easy to compare a participant's start and end — entry vs. exit test, a start-of-course and end-of-course attitudes survey, and improvement in teaching across sessions.

- **Elective phases** — Some phases (technology, practicum) are optional depending on circumstances. We would like to be able to switch these on or off per cohort, with the assessment weightings adjusting accordingly.

5. Open Questions & Next Steps

We would value your input on the following :

- Which parts of our assessment framework (Section 3) are straightforward, and which need genuine custom development?
- What would a sensible phased rollout look like — what is the minimum first version that delivers value?
- What have we not thought of that we should?

Next step

We would like to discuss this brief with you and hear your recommended approach.